

PAVAN KUMAR NAYAKANTI

Cloud Infrastructure & Platform Leader | AWS | IaC | FinOps | VMware | Hybrid Cloud | Regulated SaaS

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Hyderabad, India

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cloud infrastructure leader with 20+ years governing and modernising enterprise platforms across AWS, hybrid cloud, and on-premise estates for regulated financial institutions - ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO, and RBC. Track record of owning the full infrastructure layer: AWS account governance, IaC-driven provisioning (Terraform, AWS CDK/CloudFormation), FinOps cost optimisation, VMware virtualisation, identity & access, and engineering team leadership. Experienced scaling cloud platform teams from the ground up and driving infrastructure automation that eliminates manual operations at scale. Now targeting a Director, Cloud Operations role to own the foundational platform layer at a high-growth GCC.

CORE COMPETENCIES

AWS Platform Governance | IaC - Terraform & CloudFormation/CDK | FinOps & Cost Optimisation | VMware vSphere Virtualisation | Hybrid Cloud Infrastructure | Identity & Access Management (IAM) | Network & VPC Architecture | Engineering Team Leadership | Compute / Storage / SAN | Compliance & Patching (SOX/GDPR) | Cloud Migration (On-Prem to AWS) | AI Tools as Force Multiplier

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & DevOps AWS (Organizations, Control Tower, VPC, IAM, ECS Fargate, Lambda, ALB, Route 53, CDK, CloudFormation), Microsoft Azure, Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, Terraform, Ansible, Jenkins, Azure DevOps, GitLab, GitHub Actions, VMware vSphere

Observability Prometheus, Grafana, Dynatrace, MS Application Insights, Splunk, Telegraf

DevSecOps SonarQube, JFrog Artifactory, SAST/DAST/IAST, shift-left security, SOX/GDPR CI/CD, IAM governance

Automation Python, Ansible, Bash, PowerShell, CI/CD pipelines, RPA (UiPath, Automation Anywhere)

Storage & Networking Storage Area Network (SAN), VPC architecture, DNS, load balancing (ALB), CDN

AI / ML GenAI (AWS Bedrock, Azure OpenAI), AIOps, MLOps, AI-102, DP-100

ITSM ITIL, ServiceNow, Incident/Problem/Change Management, Privileged Access Management

WORK EXPERIENCE

Sr. Specialist - Cloud Practice & Infrastructure Lead

Sep 2020 - Present

IRIS Software | India

Clients: ADP | Charles Schwab | BMO Financial Group

Cloud platform governance and infrastructure delivery lead across three major banking clients - owning AWS estate management, IaC provisioning standards, FinOps, VMware hybrid infrastructure, and engineering team buildout at enterprise scale.

AWS PLATFORM GOVERNANCE & INFRASTRUCTURE

- Governed AWS cloud estate for BMO - account structure, VPC architecture, IAM policies, Route 53 DNS, ALB configuration, and CDK/CloudFormation-driven provisioning standards across the engineering organisation.
- Led end-to-end on-premise to AWS cloud migration for BMO CCB: delivered CDK-enabled deployment pipelines for .NET applications across ECS Fargate containers and Lambda functions - HA and DR architecture embedded from day one.
- Managed VMware vSphere virtualised workloads as part of ADP's hybrid infrastructure platform prior to cloud migration - governed compute, network, and storage configuration across the virtualised estate.
- Drove AWS FinOps practices for BMO - systematic identification of obsolete, unused, and underutilised resources; rightsizing workloads to actual demand; delivering measurable cloud waste reduction across the AWS estate.
- Enforced IAM governance and privileged access controls across multi-account AWS environments, aligning with SOX/GDPR compliance requirements and audit-readiness standards.

IAC, AUTOMATION & OPERATIONAL EXCELLENCE

- Architected Terraform-driven IaC delivery across ADP's platform, standardising infrastructure provisioning and eliminating configuration drift - enabling repeatable, policy-compliant deployments at scale.
- Delivered high-throughput deployment automation platform (modeas) handling 200+ builds/deployments per hour - eliminating 10,000+ manual operational hours annually and accelerating deployment cadence by 600%.
- Implemented ITIL-aligned change management - structured RCA workflows, cross-team postmortems, privileged access controls, and measurable improvement in change success rate and incident trends.

- Led GCP landing zone preparation and workload migration POCs for Charles Schwab; executed cross-platform artifact deployment alignment across TD Ameritrade and Charles Schwab as part of merger integration.

TEAM LEADERSHIP & ENGINEERING MANAGEMENT

- Scaled ADP's infrastructure and SRE engineering org from 4 to 40 engineers across India, Canada, and the US - including hiring, onboarding, and engineering management structures.
- Built Charles Schwab's 18-member Platform Engineering team from the ground up, establishing foundational infrastructure governance, reliability reviews, and incident management.
- Designed and deployed GenAI assistants on AWS Bedrock for BMO (risk summarisation and interactive Q&A) - accelerating manual analysis and demonstrating AI as operational force multiplier.
- Presented infrastructure strategy, cloud governance outcomes, and platform roadmaps directly to VP and C-suite stakeholders at ADP, Schwab, and BMO.

Automation Technology Specialist

Jun 2018 - Sep 2020

IRIS Software | Toronto, Canada

Client: Royal Bank of Canada Insurance

- Governed enterprise-wide DevOps and change management across 250+ applications - standardising deployment workflows, enforcing SOX/GDPR compliance, and ensuring audit-ready change transparency.
- Implemented Splunk-based log aggregation and alerting pipelines integrated with CI/CD workflows, enabling proactive detection and rapid response to production incidents.
- Enabled SAST, DAST, and IAST scanning across RBC Insurance CI/CD pipelines - integrating SonarQube, Jenkins, UrbanCode, and JFrog Artifactory with shift-left security gates.
- Automated artifact retrieval and approval workflows using Python and Ansible - eliminating manual intervention and establishing compliant change evidence pipelines.
- Led enterprise migration of 250+ applications across 60+ teams from CA SCM/Harvest to GitHub - enabling modern CI/CD, agile collaboration, and self-service provisioning.

Technology Manager

Jul 2015 - Feb 2017

TechMahindra Pvt. Ltd. | Noida, India

Client: Adobe Systems

- Architected and delivered zero-downtime business application migration during Adobe's data centre relocation - owned the full plan, execution, and cutover across VMware vSphere virtualised environments, ensuring continuity across all production workloads.
- Led SAP HANA upgrades and HTTP/7 enablement, modernising Adobe's core business application stack across virtualised infrastructure.
- Executed end-to-end data and code migration from Informatica to SQL Server 2012 - schema redesign, ETL re-engineering, and data validation at enterprise scale.

Sr. SDET - Production Engineering & Infrastructure

Jul 2007 - Dec 2014

Microsoft Corporation | India

- Held dual mandate as Sr. SDET and Production Engineering owner for Sales & Marketing platforms serving US, EMEA, and APAC - sustaining 99.99% uptime over 7 years across network, infrastructure, and application tiers.
- Owned all non-functional objectives (performance, availability, scalability, security) - defining and enforcing infrastructure standards across Windows and Linux production environments.
- Managed production operations end-to-end: incident response, RCA, infrastructure administration, and cross-team coordination for zero customer-impacting incidents.
- Supported 200% user growth through infrastructure modernisation and cloud migration without degradation in platform reliability.

Earlier Roles

2002 - 2015

Semantic Space Technologies | DRDO | NFC | India

- Automation Architect, IRIS Software (2017-2018): Designed container-orchestrated deployment pipelines (Kubernetes, Helm) and led RPA practice delivery across Insurance & Capital Markets.
- Semantic Space / Bank of America (2005-2007): L3 infrastructure support, release management, and ETL delivery for 3,000+ user Statusmart platform.
- DRDO / NFC (2002-2005): Systems development and on-premise infrastructure for defence-grade high-reliability applications.

EDUCATION

Masters in Artificial Intelligence - Woolf University

2024

General Management Program (GMP) - ISB Hyderabad

2022

M.Sc in Computer Science - Osmania University

2002

CERTIFICATIONS

- ♦ Certified SRE (ISRE)
 - ♦ Google Cloud Certified - Professional Cloud Architect - 2026
- ♦ AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate (SAA-C01) - 2026
 - ♦ Microsoft Certified: Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305) - 2026

- ♦ Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD) - 2025
- ♦ Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Engineer Associate (AI-102)
- ♦ ITIL® Certificate in IT Service Operations
- ♦ Microsoft Certified IT Professional (MCIT)

- ♦ Prometheus Certified Associate (PCA) - 2026
- ♦ Microsoft Certified: Azure Data Scientist Associate (DP-100)
- ♦ PMI Agile Certified Professional (PMI-ACP)
- ♦ 6σ Yellow Belt (2016)